would always make my way through to Wes' room and feel safe.

The substantial age difference could easily have been a barrier but, just like Jan, Wes was always happy to indulge his much younger brother, always willing to play, always willing to compete.

'Wes, let's play tag.'

'In a moment.'

'No, let's play now – just one game, please.'

'OK.'

The point of the game was to tag your opponent and run away so fast that he could not tag you back. In one game, I tagged Wes and set off in such blind haste that I ran straight into the knob of my bedroom door and knocked myself out. According to family legend, I was out cold for 30 minutes.

Wessels was also an outstanding young sportsman, a fine cricketer, a scratch golfer and, at one stage, the No. 1-ranked Under-14 swimmer in South Africa. Married to Carina and with two young boys, Jean and Josuah, he now owns four thriving Nando's restaurants located in the area north of Pretoria.

When the De Villiers brothers were not playing sport, we were watching sport.

We watched at the stadium when my father bundled us into the car and took us to the cricket at Centurion Park or the Wanderers, or to the rugby at Loftus Versfeld or Ellis Park in Johannesburg.

In 1995, when Allan Donald unleashed a barrage against Mike Atherton, the England captain, at the Wanderers, we were sitting on the old wooden benches at the Bullring, cheering wildly each time the heroic fast bowler completed an over and came to field on the fine-leg boundary right in front of us.

And we watched everything else on television.

In March 1992, my brothers and I were woken very early in the morning and allowed to sit bleary-eyed and watch Kepler Wessels' side beat